

Chapter-16 : Vocabulary

Synonyms

A synonym is a word similar in meaning to another word.

Word	Synonym	Word	Synonym
abandon	leave	gain	profit
abrupt	sudden	glance	look
acknowledge	admit	grave	serious
admire	praise	haste	hurry
affection	love	heed	attention
altitude	height	hollow	empty
ample	plentiful	humble	modest
anticipate	expect	illegal	unlawful
anxious	worried	indolent	lazy
arrogant	proud	intention	purpose
assistance	help	intoxicated	drunk
astonishment	surprise	jovial	joyous
awful	terrible	liberty	freedom
benefit	advantage	lofty	high
brief	short	mute	silent
calm	peaceful	obstinate	stubborn
capture	seize	odour	smell
cause	reason	persuade	coax
cautious	careful	prompt	quick
cease	stop	queer	strange
certain	sure	rapid	fast
clumsy	awkward	rare	uncommon
coarse	rough	recollect	remember
commence	start	reduce	decrease
compel	force	regret	sorrow
conceal	hide	remedy	cure
confess	admit	reluctantly	unwillingly
consequence	result	reside	stay
conversation	talk	significance	importance
deceive	cheat	slender	slim
defect	fault	solitude	loneliness
deficiency	shortage	summit	top
depart	leave	tidy	clean
desire	wish	tremble	shake
disperse	scatter	triumph	victory
distinct	clear	vacant	empty
drowsy	sleepy	vain	useless
edible	eatable	value	worth
eminent	famous	vanish	disappear
envy	jealousy	vast	huge
enormous	huge	verdict	judgement
enquire	ask	want	need
evidence	proof	wasteful	extravagant
exhibit	show	weary	tired
fertile	productive	wreck	destroy
forgive	pardon	yield	produce
frequently	often	yearn	desire
frightened	scared	zeal	passion
generously	liberally	zenith	peak

Antonyms

An antonym is a word opposite in meaning to another word.

Word	Antonym	Word	Antonym
above	below	early	late
accept	reject	earn	spend
acknowledge	deny	empty	full
acquit	convict	excess	shortage
admit	deny	fair	foul
adversity	prosperity	familiar	strange
affirm	deny	gather	disperse
allow	forbid	genuine	false
alone	together	gloomy	happy
always	never	guilty	innocent
ancient	modern	hide	show
angry	pleased	hinder	help
arrival	departure	honour	shame
artificial	natural	humble	proud
assemble	disperse	ignorance	knowledge
attack	defend	inferior	superior
attract	repel	join	separate
beautiful	ugly	lenient	strict
begin	end	living	dead
beneficial	harmful	loose	tight
better	worse	lose	find
birth	death	loud	low
bitter	sweet	major	minor
blame	praise	make	mar
blessing	curse	miser	spendthrift
blunt	sharp	neat	untidy
bold	timid	noise	silence
brave	cowardly	odd	even
bright	dull	offer	refuse
broad	narrow	often	seldom
build	destroy	open	shut
capture	release	pain	pleasure
cheap	expensive	peace	war
cheerful	gloomy	permanent	temporary
common	rare	profit	loss
coarse	fine	public	private
condemn	approve	quiet	noisy
confess	deny	shorten	lengthen
contract	expand	smile	frown
create	destroy	tame	wild
credit	debit	timid	fearless
crude	refined	urban	rural
cruel	kind	vacant	full
dangerous	safe	vague	clear
deceitful	honest	victory	defeat
deep	shallow	virtue	vice
deposit	withdraw	warm	cool
despair	hope	wicked	virtuous
divide	unite	wise	foolish

Prefixes and Suffixes

Prefix: A prefix is an addition in the beginning of a word, which changes its form and meaning. The meaning of a prefix helps a lot in understanding the meaning of a new word. Read the table given below carefully to understand the meaning of different prefixes and their use in words.

Prefix	Meaning	Examples
ab-	negation,	abnormal
ambi-	both	ambidextrous, ambiguous
ante-	before, preceding	antecedent, antenatal
anti-	against	anti-social, anti-terrorism,
bene-	good, well	beneficial, benevolent
bi-	two	bimonthly, bilingual, bicycle
bio-	life	biology, biography
co-	with, jointly, completely	co-author, co-operate, co-educate
dis-	negation, removal, expel	dishonest, disagree, disapprove
en-/em-	put into or on	encircle, empower
ex-	out	exterior, exchange
il-/ir-	not, without	illegal, irresponsible
im-/in-	not, without	impossible, inevitable
inter-	between, among	international, interdisciplinary
mis-	bad, wrongly	misunderstand, misbehave
mono-	single	monologue, monosyllabic
multi-	many	multicoloured, multinational
non-	not	non-violence, non-academic
over-	more than, excessive	overenthusiastic, overestimated
post-	after, later	post-colonial, post-independence
pre-	before	pre-historic, pre-primary
re-	again	research, reinvestigate
sub-	at a lower position	sub-inspector, subordinate,
trans-	beyond	translucent, transmission
un-	not, reverse	unable, unconscious, unexpected

Exercise: Add prefixes to the following words to form their antonyms.

please		correct	
aware		fortune	
legal		known	
respect		loyal	
agree		ordinary	
effective		patient	
capable		pure	
moral		real	
formal		relevant	
regular		valid	

Suffix: A suffix is an addition at the end of a word, which changes its form and meaning. Suffixes often change the part of speech of a word. Read the table given below carefully to understand the use of different suffixes.

Suffix	Examples
-al	approval, denial, burial, habitual, mythical
-ance	abundance, acceptance, defiance, performance
-dom	freedom, kingdom, martyrdom, wisdom
-ee	employee, payee, nominee, flee
-en	strengthen, fasten, hasten, broaden
-ence	correspondence, excellence, existence
-er	writer, preacher, reader, heater, cooker
-ful	beautiful, careful, harmful, joyful
-fy	beautify, clarify, fructify, classify
-hood	boyhood, childhood, falsehood, priesthood
-ism	criticism, mysticism, mechanism
-ist	economist, terrorist, optimist, pessimist
-ity	ability, agility, vicinity, validity
-ize	apologize, apologize, criticize, memorize,
-less	careless, hopeless, shameless, speechless
-ly	quickly, carefully, intelligently, worldly
-ment	achievement, astonishment, management
-ness	quickness, keenness, nervousness, newness
-or	mentor, professor, transgressor, tractor
-ous	dangerous, auspicious, ridiculous, humorous
-ship	friendship, citizenship, kingship
-th	health, wealth, breadth, width, strength
-y	smoky, gloomy, healthy, sleepy,

Exercise: Add suffixes to the following words to form new words.

move		replace	
guide		rely	
confer		refer	
try		create	
agitate		promote	
revise		vacate	
propose		arrange	
add		execute	
flatter		describe	
depart		fail	
please		grow	
notify		heal	

Homophones

Homophones are the words that have the same pronunciation, but different spelling and meaning.

1. **Ad:** A short form of the word advertisement
Add: A short form of the word addition
2. **Ail:** To be ill or sick
Ale: A beer
3. **Allowed:** That which is permitted
Aloud: Spoken in a loud manner
4. **Alter:** A raised platform used as a place of worship
Alter: To change
5. **Ate:** Past Tense of the word eat
Eight: The number that comes after seven and before nine
6. **Bail:** Temporary release of an accused from the jail
Bale: a bundle of hay or cotton
7. **Bare:** Naked or without any covering
Bear: A large heavy animal with thick fur
8. **Berth:** a seat in a train
Birth: the beginning of life
9. **Bite:** Use teeth to cut something into pieces
Byte: A group of binary digits or bits
10. **Break:** To divide something into pieces
Brake: A device used to stop a moving vehicle
11. **Carat:** A unit of weight for precious stones and pearls
Carrot: A tapering orange-coloured root eaten as a vegetable
12. **Cell:** Smallest unit of life
Sell: Give or hand over in exchange of money
13. **Coarse:** Rough or harsh in texture
Course: The route or direction followed by a ship, aircraft, road or river
14. **Compliment:** A polite expression of praise or admiration
Complement: A thing that contributes extra features to something else
15. **Fair:** Treating people equally, just or appropriate in the circumstances
Fare: The money a passenger on public transport has to pay
16. **Hail:** Pellets of frozen rain falling in showers
Hale: strong and healthy
17. **Heal:** To cure a disease
Heel: The hind part of the foot
18. **Idle:** Avoiding work, lazy
Idol: An image or representation of a god used as an object of worship
19. **Knead:** To work dough or clay with hands
Need: Something one must have
20. **Lessen:** To reduce or bring down in number
Lesson: A thing that is learnt
21. **Our:** belonging to speaker and one or more persons
Hour: a unit of time equal to sixty minutes
22. **Pail:** A bucket
Pale: Containing little colour or pigmentation

23. **Pair:** A set of two
Pear: A yellowish or brownish-green edible fruit
24. **Pain:** A hurting body sensation
Pane: A single sheet of glass in a window or door
25. **Principal:** the head of a school
Principle: A fundamental truth or proposition, a theory or rule
26. **Root:** A part of a plant which grows underground in the soil
Route: A way or course taken in getting from a starting point to a destination
27. **Story:** An account of imaginary or real people and events told for entertainment
Storey: A floor of a building
28. **Sunday:** The day of the week before Monday and after Saturday
Sundae: A dish or ice cream with added fruit, nuts and syrup or chocolate
29. **Vale:** A valley
Veil: A fine material worn to protect or conceal
30. **Waist:** The part of human body
Waste: To use carelessly, extravagantly or without specific purpose

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with the correct word chosen from the options given.

1. We need.....as fuel. (wood/would)
2. Please, come.....(here/hear).
3. Hitesh took two loaves of.....(bread/bred).
4. This is thetime to talk to the teacher. (right/write)
5. This movie has been.....(band/banned).
6. Why are.....disturbing him? (yew/you)
7. Can you.....the moon? (sea/see)
8. I saw two.....in the forest. (dear/deer)
9. He applied.....to stop the car. (break/brake)
10. Thewas proud of its swiftness and speed. (hair/hare)
11. She gave.....to a son. (birth/berth)
12. Who has broken the window(pain/pane)?
13. Mrs. Bhatnagar is the.....of our school. (principal/principle)
14. You should not sit.....(idle/idol).
15. An octopus hasarms. (ate/eight)

Homographs

A homograph is a word with the same spelling and pronunciation used in a different meaning

1. **Arms:** His arms are very thin.
Arms: The soldiers laid down their arms.
2. **Bat:** He has bought a new cricket bat.
Bat: There is a bat on this tree.
3. **Box:** What is there in this box?
Box: The fighters will box tomorrow.
4. **Bank:** My father works in a bank.
Bank: There was a mango tree on the bank of the river.
5. **Bulb:** The light bulb was invented by Edison.
Bulb: We planted a rose bulb.
6. **Bed:** My bed is made of wood.
Bed: Life is not a bed of roses.
7. **Coat:** He is wearing a coat.
Coat: She applied two coats of nail paint.
8. **Fast:** A horse runs very fast.
Fast: My mother is on fast today.
9. **File:** You should file all these papers.
File: You should file your nails.
10. **Fly:** A fly landed on his hand.
Fly: Birds fly in the sky.
11. **Jam:** I like bread with apple jam.
Jam: He was held up in a traffic jam.
12. **Kind:** We should be kind to animals.
Kind: This is not a good kind of cloth.
13. **Last:** This is the last chapter in the book.
Last: The meeting will last for two hours.
14. **Match:** I need a match box.
Match: They played a cricket match.
15. **Lie:** We should never tell a lie.
Lie: You can lie down here.
16. **Park:** There is a park in front of my house.
Park: You cannot park your car here.
17. **Pool:** We have a pool table in our school.
Pool: There is a swimming pool in his mansion.
18. **Rose:** The rose is a pretty flower.
Rose: The crowd rose to greet the queen.
19. **Train:** We travelled by a train.
Train: The coach will train the players.
20. **Well:** He jumped into the well.
Well: This article is very well-written